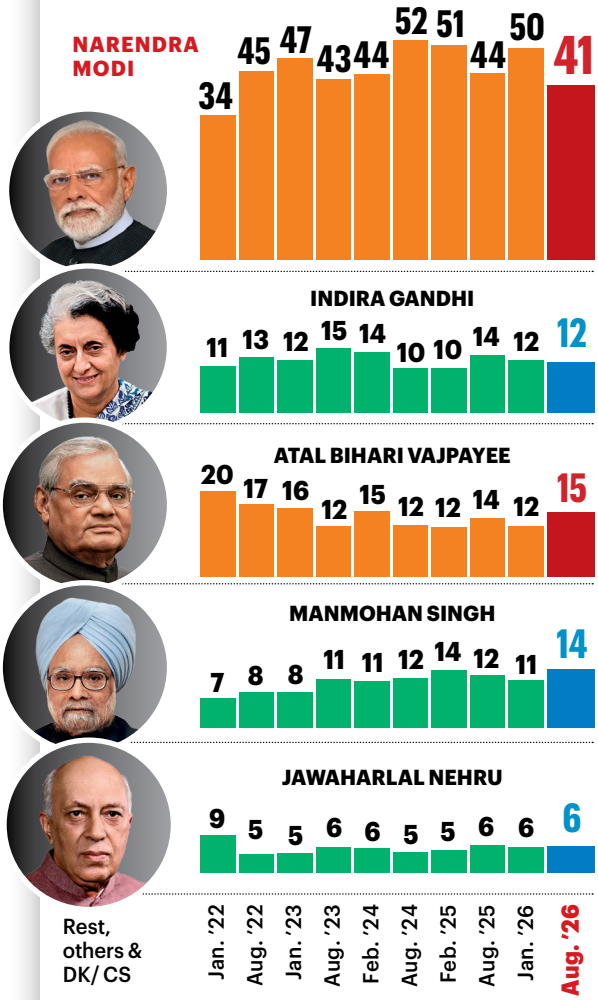
Q. Who has been the best prime minister of India so far?



Modi's lead slips by nearly 10 percentage points, but Vajpayee and Singh see a rise

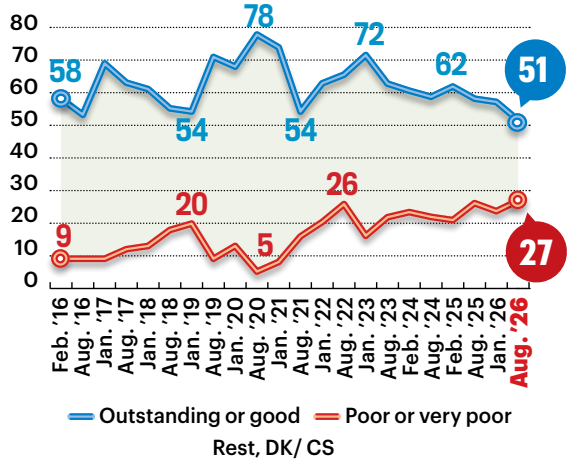
the 2024 Lok Sabha election. The Congress's vote share has also climbed from 19.6 per cent to 21.1 per cent, an increase of 1.5 percentage points. This has helped lift INDIA's overall vote share marginally to 39.1 per cent in the current poll, though it remains below the 40.6 per cent it secured in the 2024 Lok Sabha election.

If the BJP has seen its numbers fall, Modi, its most iconic leader, has also suffered a drop in personal popularity in this poll. Asked who is best suited to be India's next prime minister, Modi's rating has fallen six percentage points, from 54.7 per cent in the January MOTN to 48.7 per cent now. American president Donald Trump would probably whoop with joy at ratings like these, but for Modi, slipping below the 50 per cent mark is a warning signal, especially since his rating peaked at 66 per cent in August 2020, in the thick of the first wave of COVID-19 and barely a year into his second term. Modi's rating subsequently fell to an all-time low of 24 per cent in January 2021, but has since remained largely in the 50 per cent range.

NO COMFORT FOR RAHUL

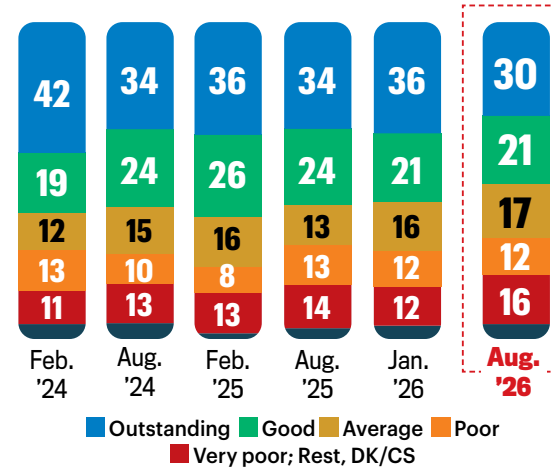
Rahul Gandhi, Modi's principal challenger, has not gained much traction from the prime minister's six-point slide. His rating has inched up to 27.1 per cent, a rise of just 0.5 percentage points from the previous MOTN. To Rahul's credit, though, across the past five MOTNs, he has maintained a steady average of around 25 per cent, after falling to a low of 13.8 per cent in February 2024 ahead of the Lok Sabha election. The surprise in this MOTN is the rapid rise of Tamil Nadu chief minister Vijay, who makes an eye-opening debut with a 9.2 per cent rating, far ahead of Mamata Banerjee, Akhilesh Yadav and Arvind Kejriwal. CJP national convenor Abhijeet Dipke, a former AAP member, also makes an unexpected entry, with

MODI'S PERFORMANCE ACROSS MOTNs



Record low for PM Modi since '16: highest share of respondents rate him 'poor', lowest share 'good'

Q. How would you rate Modi's performance as prime minister?



Fewer share of respondents rate PM Modi's performance as 'outstanding' this time around

All figures in % and rounded off; DK/ CS: Don't know/ can't say